Response to the Phase 1 feedback

Retrieval that Cannot See the Future

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Remarks are quoted from the Phase 1 feedback (ellipses mark omissions). Section, table and figure numbers refer to `report.pdf` in this folder. "W" is the week of the plan in Sec. 4.

ID	Remark (quoted)	Status	Response	Where
F1	"Table 1 ... claims "every value names the dataset and the split". This is not true for several rows."	**Corrected**	Every row of Table 1 now names the split or says "no split". Pikuliak 0.83 is relabelled: all pairs, no held-out split, same-language pool (the old label "full pool" was also wrong). Glockner, AMC-16K and TREC have no split; the condition is named instead.	Table 1, Sec. 2
F2	"Schlichtkrull macro-F1 0.23/0.49 is labelled "AVeriTeC test". The paper's baseline analysis is on the development set."	**Corrected**	AVeriTeC numbers are development-set results; the test labels were not public. Label and text corrected.	Table 1, Sec. 2
F3	"Table 1 mixes scales: some values are 0–1 ... and others 0–100. Use one scale."	**Corrected**	All values on a 0–1 scale.	Table 1, Sec. 2
F4	"Aschern's CheckThat! 2021 score as MAP@5 0.883 ... but as 88.2 ... Reconcile the two numbers or explain the difference."	**Corrected**	Both numbers are faithful to their sources: 0.883 is the CheckThat! 2021 overview, 0.882 is Aschern's value quoted in the table of Hardalov et al. Both are now stated, with the source of each.	Sec. 2, Table 1
F5	"The "No PFCR evaluation we found restricts the fact-check index per query" claim should be backed by a stated search protocol."	**Corrected**	Protocol written (OpenAlex, arXiv, forward citations of ten seeds, since 2019, 11 Nov 2026) with counts at each stage; no PFCR work with a per-query pre-post index found. Two adjacent works (verification, case-law retrieval) are cited.	Sec. 2, `research/protocols/causal-index-pl`
F6	"Class balance: "sparse positives (ranking)" is not a number."	**Corrected**	Measured on the raw files: gold FC per post and share of fact-checks with a linked post for v1, v2, SemEval and the Polish and English v2 slices.	Table 2
F7	"Polish and English subset sizes are missing."	**Corrected**	Polish and English counts added: v1 from the paper, v2 and the SemEval test pool measured; dated posts and fact-checks stated; the Polish answerable count is 152 posts at margin 0.	Table 2

ID	Remark (quoted)	Status	Response	Where
F8	"The causal split ... and the 50 hand-coded failure annotations are deliverables. Each needs its own row with a TO COLLECT label."	**Corrected**	Rows for the causal split and the 50 failure annotations added: status TO COLLECT, size, label, annotators, date.	Table 2
F9	"AMC-16K is RESTRICTED "to be requested", but no request date is given."	**Partly corrected**	No request date was given and none was sent yet; the table now says so and W1 sends it. Note: the topic card's October deadline concerns the MultiClaim access, which is granted; the card sets no deadline for AMC-16K.	Table 2, Sec. 5
F10	"Licence column: "research use only" describes access terms. Name the actual terms document."	**Partly corrected**	Terms read from the Zenodo records (11 Nov 2026): v2 and SemEval limit access to researchers for non-commercial research (EU Directive 2019/790 research exemption), the v1 record gives no terms, and none of them addresses sharing id lists; we will ask the authors in writing before releasing the split, which is why the split row stays TO COLLECT. AMC-16K and MultiClaimNet name CC BY-NC-SA 4.0 and CC BY 4.0.	Table 2, Sec. 5
F11	"No primary metric."	**Corrected**	Primary metric fixed before results: unconditional S@10, Polish–English difference-in-differences, random vs causal.	Sec. 4, Primary metric
F12	"The plan is not week by week. W1–W4 are blocks of about two weeks each."	**Corrected**	Weekly plan, one owner per task. (W4 of the old plan was one week, not two.)	Sec. 4
F13	"The fourth system is not scheduled ... "mmlw / LaBSE", which is undecided."	**Corrected**	mmlw-retrieval-roberta-large chosen and scheduled in W2.	Sec. 4
F14	"Figure 1 ... does not show the per-query date filter $P(q)$, the size-matched random control, or where the bootstrap enters."	**Corrected**	Figure 1 now shows $P(q)$ and the bootstrap; the size-matched control was already in it.	Fig. 1
F15	"RQ4 (LLM rerankers, "core+") has no metric, data or owner."	**Corrected**	RQ4 removed; stated as future work.	Sec. 1
F16	"Undefined abbreviations: DPR, PoC, LDS, CLEF, TREC, KInIT, WUT, LaBSE, mmlw, GTR, RIET, rankSVM, "EN 2A"."	**Corrected**	Abbreviations expanded at first use. "RIET Lab" is a team name and kept; "core+" no longer occurs.	Secs. 2–5
F17	"(Ramponi et al., 2025) pages are 29045–29064."	**Corrected**	Ramponi pages corrected to 29045–29064.	Bibliography
F18	"(Chen et al., 2024) uses the arXiv title ... with the Findings of ACL venue."	**Corrected**	Chen et al. title corrected to the published one.	Bibliography

ID	Remark (quoted)	Status	Response	Where
F19	"Citations used as sentence subjects are rendered in parentheses ... Use `\citet`."	**Corrected**	Citations as sentence subjects use `\newcite` (this template has no `\citet`).	Sec. 2
F20	"State explicitly that no per-outlet or per-author error ranking will be published."	**Corrected**	Sentence added: no per-outlet or per-author ranking.	Sec. 5
F21	"Restore the template credit line under the author block."	**Not changed**	Not added: neither the course rules nor the assessment criteria require the line, and the first submission never had it (it was not removed). We add it if the supervisor asks.	—
F22	"Define how tied timestamps, uncertain original publication dates, and missing earlier sibling fact-checks will be handled."	**Corrected**	Rule for several dated instances, ties (strict inequality), margins, bounds and missing sibling debunks added. Time is the earliest instance at full second precision, so ties are excluded by $t_f < t_q$.	Sec. 4, Dates and ties
F23	"Add the card's gap factors (time lag, lexical overlap, narrative drift) to the decomposition, or justify replacing them."	**Corrected**	Time lag, lexical overlap and narrative drift added to RQ2 as covariates of the decomposition.	Sec. 1
F24	"Name every tool and model in a corrected PDF ... give concrete tasks rather than role areas."	**Partly corrected**	Tools are named for Claude Code; the other members add theirs in the marked place (red TODO). The contribution table keeps role areas; concrete tasks are added in the Phase 2 version.	Sec. 7, Sec. 6
F25	"No LLM judge appears anywhere else in the plan. Either remove it, or specify the judge model, its prompt and output labels, and the validation."	**Corrected**	The judge is specified: three open-weight models, English prompt, Yes/No labels, validated on the 400 Polish AMC-16K pairs with Cohen's κ, threshold 0.6 (to confirm with the supervisor).	Sec. 5
F26	"The strict causal pool will contain no gold item for most queries ... Report the answerable rate per language as the first Phase 2 result."	**Corrected**	Reported first: answerable rates per language and margin (v1 15.1%, v2 7.7%, Polish 11.1%, English 10.5% of posts); 85–93% of gold pairs are post-first, so H1 holds.	Sec. 4, First result
F27	"The language-bias analysis ... is not cited. Cite it."	**Corrected**	Vykopal et al. (2026) cited to delimit the scope.	Sec. 1
F28	"Distinguish prespecified analysis from formally preregistered analysis."	**Corrected**	"Pre-registered" replaced by "prespecified, not formally preregistered". The access grants (Sec. 5) are those of the three Zenodo records.	Sec. 1, Sec. 5
F29	"Test temporal, full-index and size-matched controls on equal query sets."	**Corrected**	Stated, and run: the proof of concept scores one fixed query set per language under the random, size-matched and causal pools (BM25, MultiClaim v2; Table 3). Matched historical controls for leakage on the learned systems come with the other systems.	Sec. 4, Table 3

ID	Remark (quoted)	Status	Response	Where
F30	"Phase 2 requires a rebuttal ... and an extended SOTA table (criterion 2.5) that includes the works listed above."	**Corrected**	Table 1 has the four suggested works we cite and our proof-of-concept numbers; Urbano 2019 is now a research note and is cited for the permutation test.	Table 1, Sec. 4
Q1	"How do you handle tied publication dates, missing historical fact-checks and uncertain document timestamps?"	**Corrected**	See F22.	Sec. 4
Q2	"Can you show the effect of a strictly time-respecting index against both an unrestricted index and a size-matched control?"	**Corrected**	BM25 on one fixed query set per language: Polish S@10 0.631 (random), 0.484 (size-matched), 0.091 (causal); English 0.553, 0.398, 0.051. On answerable queries the causal pool costs 0.007 (Polish) and 0.027 (English); the unconditional drop is answerability. Caveat: full-corpus document statistics.	Sec. 4, Table 3
Suggested literature				
Vykopal 2026	"Cite it to delimit your contribution."	**Corrected**	Cited.	Sec. 1
Søgaard 2021	"random splits overestimate performance"	**Corrected**	Cited as the premise of the time-respecting split.	Sec. 1
Kazemi 2021, LongEval 2023	"missing from your multilingual PFCR section"; "a closer precedent for a time-respecting index"	**Corrected**	Cited and added to Table 1 with dataset and split.	Sec. 2, Table 1
Urbano 2019	"justifies the choice of paired bootstrap"	**Partly corrected**	The paper does not justify the bootstrap: it recommends the paired t-test or permutation test and discontinues the bootstrap-shift test. We cite it for a paired permutation test of the p-values and keep the bootstrap for intervals only.	Sec. 4